CLASS NOTES · TAFSIR SURAH MARYAM

Surah Maryam: *Ayat 23–34*

Wednesday, 7 October 2026 | Surah ke-19 · 98 ayat · Makkiyyah | Maryam gives birth, and Nabi Isa a.s. speaks from the cradle

IN SHORT

- Maryam, alone in labour, was told: don't grieve, shake the palm, eat, stay silent.
- Nabi Isa's first words from the cradle: "I am the servant of Allah."
- He wasn't killed — he was raised, and will return before the Hour.

1. About the surah

MATTER	DETAILS
Position	Surah 19; after Al-Kahf, before Taha · Juz 16
Order of revelation	44th — after Fatir, before Taha
Named after	The story of Maryam and her son Nabi Isa a.s. (ayat 16–33)
Main purpose	Declaring Allah free of partners, wife or child; He alone is Creator and Giver (19:35, 19:88–92)
Special feature	The surah that mentions **Ar-Rahman** the most — 16 times

Structure: ayat 1 opening (five letters) · **Part 1 (2–65)** Allah's mercy on the prophets — Zakariyya & Yahya, **Maryam & Isa (16–40)**, Ibrahim, Musa and others · **Part 2 (66–95)** answering the musyrikin's doubts · ayat 96–98 closing.

> **Maryam's rank:** the Prophet ﷺ drew four lines in the ground and said the best women of Jannah are Khadijah binti Khuwailid, Fatimah binti Muhammad, Asiah binti Muzahim (wife of Firaun) and Maryam binti 'Imran (Musnad Ahmad 2668, 2901 · sahih isnad, Ahmad Syakir & al-Arna'ut).

2. Text & meaning, word by word

Grouped into phrases so the meaning reads naturally.

23

فَأَجَاءَهَا — maka membawanya
الْمَخَاضُ — sakit bersalin
إِلَىٰ جِذْعِ النَّخْلَةِ — ke pangkal pohon kurma
قَالَتْ — dia berkata
يَا لَيْتَنِي مِتُّ — alangkah baiknya aku mati
قَبْلَ هَٰذَا — sebelum ini
وَكُنتُ نَسْيًا مَّنسِيًّا — dan menjadi sesuatu yang dilupakan terus

Sakit bersalin memaksanya (bersandar) ke pangkal pohon kurma. Dia berkata: Alangkah baiknya kalau aku mati sebelum ini dan menjadi sesuatu yang dilupakan terus.

24

فَنَادَاهَا	مِن تَحْتِهَا	أَلَّا تَحْزَنِي	قَدْ جَعَلَ رَبُّكِ	تَحْتَكِ
lalu dia diseru	dari bawahnya	janganlah engkau bersedih	Tuhanmu telah menjadikan	di bawahmu

سَرِيًّا
anak sungai

Lalu dia diseru dari bawahnya: Janganlah bersedih; Tuhanmu telah menjadikan anak sungai di bawahmu.

25

وَهُزِّي إِلَيْكِ	بِجِذْعِ النَّخْلَةِ	تُسَاقِطْ عَلَيْكِ	رُطَبًا جَنِيًّا
dan goyangkanlah ke arahmu	pangkal pohon kurma	nescaya gugur kepadamu	kurma segar yang masak

Goyangkanlah pangkal pohon kurma itu ke arahmu, nescaya gugur kepadamu kurma segar yang masak.

26

فَكُلِي وَاشْرَبِي	وَقَرِّي عَيْنًا	فَإِمَّا تَرَيِنَّ مِنَ الْبَشَرِ أَحَدًا
maka makanlah dan minumlah	dan tenangkanlah hatimu	jika engkau melihat seseorang
فَقُولِي إِنِّي نَذَرْتُ	لِلرَّحْمَٰنِ صَوْمًا	فَلَنْ أُكَلِّمَ الْيَوْمَ إِنسِيًّا
katakanlah: aku telah bernazar	kepada Ar-Rahman untuk berpuasa (diam)	maka aku tidak akan bercakap dengan sesiapa hari ini

Makanlah, minumlah dan tenangkanlah hatimu. Jika engkau melihat sesiapa, katakan: Aku bernazar puasa (diam) kerana Ar-Rahman, maka aku tidak akan bercakap dengan sesiapa pun hari ini.

27

فَأَتَتْ بِهِ قَوْمَهَا	تَحْمِلُهُ	قَالُوا يَا مَرْيَمُ	لَقَدْ جِئْتِ شَيْئًا فَرِيًّا
lalu dia membawanya kepada kaumnya	sambil mendukungnya	mereka berkata: wahai Maryam	engkau telah membawa sesuatu yang sangat besar

Dia membawa anak itu kepada kaumnya sambil mendukungnya. Mereka berkata: Wahai Maryam, engkau telah melakukan perkara yang sangat besar!

28

يَا أُخْتَ هَارُونَ	مَا كَانَ أَبُوكِ امْرَأَ سَوْءٍ	وَمَا كَانَتْ أُمُّكِ بَغِيًّا
wahai saudara perempuan Harun	bapamu bukan orang jahat	dan ibumu bukan perempuan jahat

Wahai saudara perempuan Harun, bapamu bukan orang jahat dan ibumu bukan perempuan jahat.

29

فَأَشَارَتْ إِلَيْهِ
maka dia menunjuk kepadanya

قَالُوا كَيْفَ نُكَلِّمُ
mereka berkata: bagaimana kami bercakap

مَن كَانَ فِي الْمَهْدِ صَبِيًّا
dengan bayi dalam buaian

Maka dia menunjuk kepada anaknya. Mereka berkata: Bagaimana kami mahu bercakap dengan bayi yang masih dalam buaian?

30

قَالَ إِنِّي عَبْدُ اللَّهِ
dia berkata: sesungguhnya aku hamba Allah

آتَانِيَ الْكِتَابَ
Dia memberiku Kitab

وَجَعَلَنِي نَبِيًّا
dan menjadikan aku seorang nabi

Dia (Isa) berkata: Sesungguhnya aku hamba Allah; Dia memberiku Kitab dan menjadikan aku seorang nabi.

31

وَجَعَلَنِي مُبَارَكًا
dan menjadikan aku diberkati

أَيْنَ مَا كُنتُ
di mana sahaja aku berada

وَأَوْصَانِي بِالصَّلَاةِ وَالزَّكَاةِ
dan mewasiatkan kepadaku solat dan zakat

مَا دُمْتُ حَيًّا
selagi aku hidup

Dia menjadikan aku diberkati di mana sahaja aku berada, dan mewasiatkan kepadaku solat dan zakat selagi aku hidup.

32

وَبَرًّا بِوَالِدَتِي
dan berbakti kepada ibuku

وَلَمْ يَجْعَلْنِي
dan Dia tidak menjadikan aku

جَبَّارًا شَقِيًّا
sombong lagi celaka

Dan berbakti kepada ibuku, dan Dia tidak menjadikan aku sombong lagi celaka.

33

وَالسَّلَامُ عَلَيَّ
dan salam sejahtera ke atasku

يَوْمَ وُلِدتُّ
pada hari aku dilahirkan

وَيَوْمَ أَمُوتُ
dan hari aku mati

وَيَوْمَ أُبْعَثُ حَيًّا
dan hari aku dibangkitkan hidup

Salam sejahtera ke atasku pada hari aku dilahirkan, hari aku mati, dan hari aku dibangkitkan hidup semula.

34

ذَٰلِكَ عِيسَى ابْنُ مَرْيَمَ
itulah Isa putera Maryam

قَوْلَ الْحَقِّ
kata-kata yang benar

الَّذِي فِيهِ يَمْتَرُونَ
yang mereka ragu-ragu tentangnya

Itulah Isa putera Maryam — kata-kata yang benar, yang mereka ragu-ragu tentangnya.

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3. Maryam's story in 3 phases

1. **Phase 1 — Jibril comes** (19:16–22): Maryam will conceive.
2. **Phase 2 — giving birth to Isa** (19:23–26): the focus of this class — four instructions to Maryam.
3. **Phase 3 — returning to her people** (19:27–33).

19:23 — "IF ONLY I HAD DIED BEFORE THIS"

Maryam wished for death because she imagined her name being shamed — she wanted to be something forgotten and never remembered. **Lesson:** sometimes we do speak from emotion.

Ibn Kathir: she knew she'd be tested and her people wouldn't believe her. This isn't a general licence — the Prophet ﷺ forbade wishing for death because of harm; if you must, say: "Ya Allah, hidupkanlah aku selagi hidup itu baik bagiku, dan wafatkanlah aku apabila wafat itu baik bagiku" *(Bukhari 5671). Maryam's fear was for her deen and honour, not a worldly harm.*

PHASE 2 — FOUR INSTRUCTIONS

#	AYAT	INSTRUCTION
1	19:24	Don't be sad — a voice comforts her
2	19:25	Shake the trunk of the date palm
3	19:26	Eat, drink and calm yourself
4	19:26	Make a vow of silence

19:24 — WHO CALLED OUT TO HER?

A valid difference among the salaf, both quoted by Ibn Kathir:

VIEW	HELD BY	REASONING
Jibril	Ibn 'Abbas, ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, as-Suddi and others	Isa didn't speak until Maryam brought him to her people
Nabi Isa	Mujahid, al-Hasan, Ibn Zayd; chosen by at-Tabari	Maryam pointed straight to her baby (19:29), as if she already knew he could speak. See also Ali 'Imran 3:46: "dia akan berkata-kata kepada manusia ketika dalam buaian"

The two qira'at support both readings: min tahtiha *(from beneath her) and* man tahtaha *(the one beneath her).* Sariyya *= a stream, per the majority — Ibn Kathir strengthens this because the next ayat mentions eating and drinking.*

19:25 — SHAKE THE TRUNK

Allah wants to teach us to **make an effort and move, even a little** — even at her weakest moment, alone and in labour. Grammar note: in *ilaiki* and *'alaiki*, ـكِ **(ki)** is feminine; ـكَ **(ka)** is masculine.

> *"Sesiapa yang bersarapan setiap pagi dengan tujuh biji kurma 'ajwah, racun dan sihir tidak akan memudaratkannya pada hari itu."*
>
> BUKHARI 5445 (SA'D BIN ABI WAQQAS) · SAHIH

Note: the ayat mentions rutab *(fresh dates); the hadith mentions* 'ajwah *— two separate dalil about dates, so don't merge them as if Maryam ate 'ajwah.*

19:26 — THE VOW OF SILENCE

Sauman here means **silence** (Anas, Ibn 'Abbas) — in their syariat, fasting included refraining from speech. In our syariat a vow of silence isn't prescribed: the Prophet ﷺ told a man who vowed to stand, not take shade, not speak and fast — to speak, take shade, sit, and only complete his fast (Bukhari 6704). The hikmah: Maryam didn't need to defend herself — **her defence came from Allah**, through the tongue of her baby.

PHASE 3 — 19:27–29: HER PEOPLE CONFRONT HER

Maryam stays silent because of her vow, and points to her baby. The people ask how they can talk to a baby in the cradle (*al-mahd*).

"Sister of Harun" doesn't mean the biological sister of Nabi Harun a.s. When Christians of Najran raised this, the Prophet ﷺ explained that people used to name their children after the prophets and righteous people before them (Muslim 2135). "Maryam binti 'Imran" is stated in At-Tahrim 66:12.

4. Nabi Isa a.s. — ten declarations from the cradle

Nabi Isa is the 24th of the 25 prophets and messengers named in the Quran (by the usual teaching order).

#	AYAT	DECLARATION	NOTE
1	19:30	I am the servant of Allah	Straight away denies being "son of God" or a god — he is human
2	19:30	He gave me the Book	The Injil
3	19:30	He made me a prophet	—
4	19:31	Blessed wherever I am	Receives good, then spreads much good to the places and people around him
5	19:31	Commanded to pray	—
6	19:31	...and give zakat, as long as I live	—
7	19:32	Dutiful to my mother	Why only mother? Because he had no father. Compare 19:14 — Nabi Yahya was dutiful to **both** parents
8	19:32	Not arrogant (*jabbar*)	—
9	19:32	Not wretched (*shaqiyy*)	—
10	19:33	Peace on me at three moments	The day I was born, the day I die, the day I'm raised alive

Ibn Kathir: Isa's very first words were an admission of servitude — and at the same time they cleared his mother's name. Mubarak *= a teacher of good, someone of great benefit (Mujahid).*

ISA'S BOOK AND MISSION

- **Ali 'Imran 3:48** — Allah taught Isa writing, wisdom, the Taurat and the Injil — so he mastered the Taurat too.
- **Ali 'Imran 3:50** — he confirmed the Taurat and made lawful some things previously forbidden — an "update" to the earlier syariat.

- **Al-Ma'idah 5:46** — sent following the prophets of Bani Israil, confirming the Taurat, given the Injil with guidance and light.
- **As-Saff 61:6** — Isa gave good news of a messenger after him named **Ahmad** — one of the names of Nabi Muhammad ﷺ (Bukhari 3532).

> **"Taurat = Old Testament, Injil = New Testament"?** Only as a rough analogy. The Taurat was revealed to Nabi Musa and the Injil to Nabi Isa. Today's Old Testament is a collection of many books, not just the Taurat; the New Testament is four Gospels written by later authors plus letters — not the Injil revealed to Isa. And after the Quran came, it became the *muhaimin* — guardian and measure — over the earlier books (Al-Ma'idah 5:48).

MARYAM AND ISA PROTECTED FROM SHAITAN'S TOUCH

وَإِنِّي أُعِيذُهَا بِكَ وَذُرِّيَّتَهَا مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ

"...dan aku memohon perlindungan-Mu untuknya dan zuriatnya daripada syaitan yang direjam." — the du'a of 'Imran's wife, Maryam's mother.

ALI 'IMRAN 3:36

Every child of Adam is touched by shaitan at birth and cries out from it — **except Maryam and her son** (Bukhari 3431; Muslim 2366). Abu Hurairah then recited 3:36. So it's two people, Maryam and Isa — not Isa alone.

أَعُوذُ بِكَلِمَاتِ اللَّهِ التَّامَّةِ مِنْ كُلِّ شَيْطَانٍ وَهَامَّةٍ، وَمِنْ كُلِّ عَيْنٍ لَامَّةٍ

"Aku berlindung dengan kalimah-kalimah Allah yang sempurna daripada setiap syaitan dan binatang berbisa, dan daripada setiap mata yang jahat." — the du'a the Prophet ﷺ made for al-Hasan and al-Husain, saying Nabi Ibrahim made it for Ismail and Ishaq. One we can make for our own children.

BUKHARI 3371 (IBN 'ABBAS) · SAHIH

5. The return of Nabi Isa and the signs of the Hour

The ten major signs (Muslim 2901, Hudhaifah bin Asid): the smoke, Dajjal, the Beast, the sun rising from the west, the descent of Isa son of Maryam, Ya'juj and Ma'juj, three landslides (east, west, Arabian Peninsula), and a fire from Yemen driving people to the gathering place.

The sequence of events (Muslim 2937, an-Nawwas bin Sam'an):

1. Dajjal appears between Syam and Iraq; he stays on earth 40 days.
2. Isa descends at the white minaret east of Damascus, his hands on the wings of two angels.
3. Isa pursues Dajjal and kills him at the gate of Ludd.
4. Allah tells Isa to take His servants to shelter at at-Tur.
5. Ya'juj and Ma'juj come out; Isa and his companions are besieged and make du'a.

6. Allah sends worms on their necks — they all die at once; birds carry the bodies away and rain washes the earth.
7. The earth is told: أَنْبِتِي ثَمَرَتَكِ وَرُدِّي بَرَكَتَكِ — "bring forth your fruit and restore your blessing."
8. A gentle wind takes the soul of every believer; only the worst of people remain, and the Hour comes upon them.

Isa stays on earth **40 years**, then dies and the Muslims pray over him (Abu Dawud 4324 · sahih, al-Albani, Ibn Hibban, Ahmad Syakir). Muslim 2940 mentions people living **seven years** without enmity after Dajjal — both are sahih; how scholars reconcile them is worth asking the ustaz.

NABI ISA'S APPEARANCE

Medium height, reddish-white complexion, straight hair (Bukhari 3239); reddish, curly hair, broad chest (Bukhari 3438); Ibn 'Umar's narration of the Prophet's ﷺ dream describes a man of brown complexion with straight hair, water dripping from his head (Bukhari 3441). "Medium height" repeats; details of skin and hair differ between sahih narrations — so mention which narration when sharing.

6. 19:34 and An-Nisa 4:155–159 — closing the story

- **19:34** — that is Isa: his qualities, his **true** story.
- **4:156** — because of their disbelief and their great slander against Maryam.
- **4:157** — and their claim "we killed the Messiah" — they did not kill him nor crucify him; it was made to appear so to them.
- **4:158** — rather, Allah raised him up to Himself.
- **4:159** — every one of the People of the Book will believe in him before his death.

> Putting 19:33 ("the day I die"), 4:158–159 and Abu Dawud 4324 together: Nabi Isa has **not yet died** — he was raised, will descend, and then die. And the surah itself closes the point: **19:35** — it is not befitting for Allah to take a son, glory be to Him; **19:36** — "Allah is my Lord and your Lord, so worship Him. This is the straight path."

Reflections

- **19:25 — shake first, then the dates fall.** At her weakest, Maryam was still told to move the trunk. Rezeki is from Allah, but the means must still be moved. Tawakkal isn't sitting still.
- **19:31 — "as long as I live" and "wherever I am".** Two measures at once: obligations that run our whole life, and benefit that follows us wherever we go. Is what we have benefiting people around us now?
- **19:28 — a good name is part of what we leave behind.** Her people argued from her parents' reputation. Like the wall of the two orphans (18:82), what we pass on isn't only wealth — it's our name, our du'a (3:36) and how we raised our children.
- **19:33 — three moments that are certain.** Born, die, raised. We should prepare for the second with the third in mind.

Personal notes from the Surah Maryam tafsir class, 7/10/2026, compiled for revision and sharing. All ayat and hadith checked against quran.com, sunnah.com and dorar.net. Any mistakes are mine — please tegur. والله أعلم